

# PHP

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# What is PHP?

- PHP (Hypertext Preprocessor): PHP is a widely-used open-source server-side scripting language that is especially suited for web development and can be embedded into HTML.
- It was originally created by Rasmus Lerdorf in 1994.
- PHP was originally an acronym for "Personal Home Page," reflecting its early use in creating dynamic web pages. Over time, it evolved into "PHP: Hypertext Preprocessor" to reflect its broader capabilities as a general-purpose scripting language for web development.

# Why PHP?

- PHP is one of the most popular languages for web development due to its simplicity, flexibility, and extensive community support. It is widely used for creating dynamic web applications, content management systems (CMS), e-commerce platforms, and more.

# How to use PHP?

- To start using PHP, we can:
  - Find a web host with PHP and MySQL support
  - Install a web server on your own PC, and then install PHP and MySQL

# PHP Syntax

- A PHP script can be placed anywhere in the document.
- A PHP script starts with `<?php` and ends with `?>`
- The default file extension for PHP files is `".php"`.
- A PHP file normally contains HTML tags, and some PHP scripting code.

```
<?php
    // PHP code goes here
?>
```

# Example

```
<!DOCTYPE html>
<html>
<body>
<h1>My first PHP page</h1>
<?php echo "Hello World!"; ?>
</body>
</html>
```